



Ambitious Snapchat

As an offshoot of the Sony hack, emails from a Snapchat's board member have revealed the company's future ambitions: <http://dgit.in/Snambition>



Digital health coach

A new app named "Rise" now puts a real-life digital personal health coach right in your pocket that tells you what to do. <http://dgit.in/RiseApp>

Windows 10: The resurrection

Microsoft recently revealed many new features of its upcoming OS in detail and some of them are really promising. Let's check them out.

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For the first time in its history, Microsoft is giving its latest operating system away for free! Not only that, the OS will now come bundled with a whole bunch of new features that will, hopefully, lay Windows 7 to rest.

It's FREE!

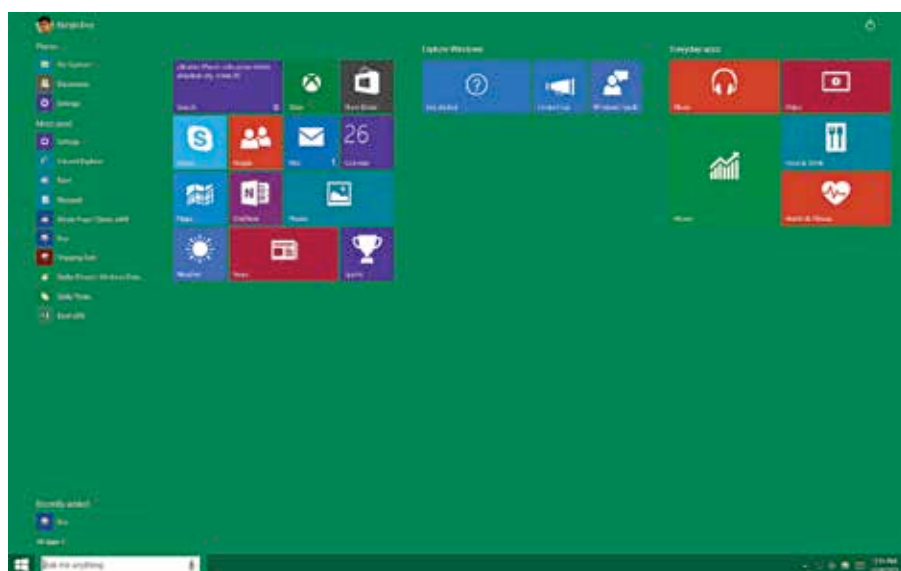
The company gathered a bunch of journalists in its Redmond headquarters, and live streamed the event to announce the next iteration of the Windows Operating System. One of the highlights of the presentation was the fact that Microsoft has finally made Windows free for existing users, at least to a certain extent.

Windows 10 will be free for Windows 7 and Windows 8.x users for the first year, which means you can upgrade for free in the first year of the OS' lifetime and enjoy free upgrades thereon. However, if you happen to upgrade in the second year or after, you will have to pay for it. Keep in mind that there's no subscription in play here, just a free upgrade during the first year of launch.

Now let's look at the changes that have been implemented since the Technical Preview last year.

Welcome to Windows 10

The Start Menu is no longer a full screen affair, but you still have the option to make it so if you want to. There's also an Action Center on the right side of the screen, which will display quick settings like in Windows Phone 8.1 and other tools to make usage simpler and faster.



Windows 10's new Start Menu

Most importantly though, Microsoft's voice assistant Cortana is coming to the desktop with the Windows 10 OS. She will take over a lot of the search functions on the PC, with her own little place right next to the Start menu.

Courting Cortana

Microsoft has announced rolling out its personal digital assistant, Cortana, to PC and tablet for the first time with Windows 10. The assistant will be available next to the Start button in the taskbar for an easier access.

At its Windows 10 event, Microsoft also briefly detailed Cortana for desktop. Along with regular voice commands, the virtual assistant allows users to search files on local storage hard drives and OneDrive. Users can also search for pictures using dates and other filters. Cortana can search for apps on the local

device as well as in Windows Store. It can be used for composing emails, Bing searches or playing music. She also lets you customise information, helping suggestions in future to be more accurate.

The assistant works across platforms, allowing users to pull information on PC and later access it on mobile devices. Cortana will also be integrated with Microsoft's new Project Spartan Browser.

"Cortana learns your preferences to provide relevant recommendations, fast access to information, and important reminders. Interaction is natural and easy via talking or typing, with advanced features to control Cortana for more trustworthiness and transparency," explains Microsoft on its blog.

Cortana is certainly an important feature of Windows 10, and perhaps will change the way users have been interacting with computers so far. However, the